Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Penny Pincher

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Penny Pincher

Eccentric Private Collector

Penny is convinced that every museum object would look better in her hallway. Penny collects small paintings, strange decorative objects, and stories about who owned them before she did.

• Shows **Vincent Van Faux** photos of paintings and asks for a free valuation.

ACTING TIPS

Eccentric, charming, nosy, unexpectedly shrewd. Ask questions that sound casual and are not.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I’m Penny Pincher. Some things in this museum belonged to my family, so you'd think I'd at least get a discount on tickets. I'm delighted about all the free food tonight, though!

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Penny Pincher

Behind the portrait

Your stake tonight

Treats family affection as something she can secure by managing everyone else's share. Cannot tolerate not being trusted with the money.

During the investigation

Keep your account private until each round. Your printed answers establish what happened. You can react in your own style, but do not invent a new event, witness, or alibi.

Conversations to start

- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page.
- Keep your private branch readings for their announced rounds.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Penny Pincher

The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Look behind the rectangle that brings distant worlds into the living room.*

2 *A vase has swallowed a document. Rescue it without disturbing the china.*

3 *Seek the green lamp; its nearest neighbor is part of this investigation.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Penny Pincher

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I bought the family shares using a damaged example as the comparison. Our piece was intact. Then I spent much more with a dealer. Grant had both figures for the handout. I removed it. I manage the family things because someone has to, you know? That used to be what they said about me. I wanted to speak to them before Grant did.

IF MURDERER

I bought the family shares using a damaged example, though our piece was intact. Grant had that price and the much higher one I paid for another work. He wanted them together in the handout. I removed it. I manage the family things. They trusted me to do that. Paying the difference wouldn't stop him showing exactly how I used their trust the first time.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Penny Pincher

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I removed the price comparison from the handouts and kept it in the sale folder. At the preview I looked closely at the bottle. Its red band looked like an auction collar. Chip said closure treatment; I asked what a modern repair did to value. I hadn't asked to open it. I ask about prices. People let that sound harmless because I smile.

IF MURDERER

I removed the price comparison from the handouts. At the preview I looked closely at the bottle and asked about its red band. Later I went to Grant's private place to discuss the family valuation. His glass was waiting; he wasn't. I put my own copy of the comparison down beside it and stayed a while. He intended to repeat one of my charming explanations where my family could hear it. I wanted to know what that silence was going to cost.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Penny Pincher

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> The band crossed the stopper. Chip's drawing showed that; I'd mistaken it for a price collar. My family has the real sheet and the corrected payment now. The comparison was damaged, our piece intact. I still haven't heard from them. How long do you leave it before calling? I am finding out that waiting is rather different when you aren't waiting for an auction result.

IF MURDERER

> The band was a loose price collar around the neck. It didn't secure or cross the stopper. The drawing concerns support treatment. A split label didn't mean the bottle was opened. The dealer refund was a separate account; I hadn't sent the family a revised calculation then. How long do you leave it before calling? I am not accustomed to waiting for people to answer me.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume

Penny Pincher

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. The drawing shows a closure band across the stopper. I was wrong about it. The family settlement pays the difference I withheld; I withdrew the refund demand based on the damaged comparison too. They may still ask someone else to manage the collection. I cannot buy that decision back. Please don't call for me. They deserve an answer in my voice, if they want one.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The band did cross the stopper. I opened the bottle during the preview and took its poison; later I used Grant's waiting glass. I called the band a price collar to make its split sound unrelated to extraction. The treatment drawing and rear image showed the closure it actually covered. I had underpaid my relatives using a comparison I could not defend. Grant could show them both prices. I had paid the difference. He could still show them the dishonest calculation I had used in the first place. I paid the difference and still wanted to prevent them hearing what I'd done. Now they will hear this, and I can't manage how they respond.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.